limiting meeting durations, while scheduling them in advance on the e-sarkar portal. "Abruptly convened but long-winded meetings affect productivity," says the babu.

Another interesting suggestion that's been accepted and successfully implemented was to seek employee feedback by installing a box outside all departments, or having anonymous digital submissions via a QR code scan. These have in turn yielded 4,000 suggestions online, almost half deemed worthy of consideration.

FROM KAIZEN TO CITIZEN

At least 10 recommendations from the second report have similarly been accepted. A silent leap in citizen services is the onboarding of technology for the issuance and management of government documents, certificates or unique IDs—including Aadhaar and EPIC cards. Each document will have a distinct QR code, helping the user seek and access authenticated documents on government websites for instant sharing. "SSC and HSC marksheets issued in May-June had a unique QR code, which will allow students to access their document online for posterity. Similarly, we have started issuing QR codes on a few caste certificates. Some 40 of the estimated 200 documents and certificates issued by the government have started getting this QR code," says the official. With software updates under way, complete coverage is expected over the next few years.

Other ideas, too, are getting accepted, or getting a hearing. Automatic pension dispersal, sans human intervention, is on. So also the integration of UPI in public transport, currently dominated by cash transactions. Bolder ideas include introducing seniority and performance-based promotion of cadre on the lines of the IAS. ■

Takeaways

- **A four-volume admin reform manual makes sweeping recos**
- **Gujarat's government offices reciprocate with a flood of ideas**

MADHYA PRADESH

OLD SCHOOL SCRIMMAGE

Indore's Daly College sees its hallowed name dragged into unseemly battle for turf control



SCREAMING SPIRES The 155-yr-old Daly College, Indore

By **Rahul Noronha**

THE DALY COLLEGE OF INDORE carries a certain elite cachet, owing to its colonial vintage and also by how it ramifies all the way into the modern hallways of power and wealth. The who's who of Madhya Pradesh politics and business can be said to have a direct or indirect stake in the 155-year-old public school. Imagine a canvas brimful with former and latter-day rajas. Add litigious busybodies to the mix. Any wonder, then, that Daly is yet again in the eye of a storm?

The prize catch: the Board of Governors, the school's apex body. In the latest ground assault, Sandeep Parekh, a board member and alumnus from 1979, has secured an order from the Assistant Registrar of Firms and Societies, Indore, directing school authorities to amend their bylaws. The effect will be to ensure the board is answerable to a bigger group: the electorate that elects five out of its nine members. Trifling matter? No, it's dominating conversations among the social elite in Indore and beyond.